



Clockwise from left: A tribute to pianist Arthur Rubinstein; Sculptures punctuate public courtyards; Murals transform city walls; Sculpture of a beloved Polish cartoon character; A public fountain

Lodz, Poland

Lodz, a UNESCO City of Film, lies slightly off the usual European routes, which is precisely what gives it its charm. Its main thoroughfare is Piotrkowska Street, one of the longest commercial streets in Europe. Nineteenth-century facades, murals in all their permutations, and a Walk of Fame honouring Polish celebrities make strolling through the city a way of reading its story. Along the street and in nearby squares, you encounter public tributes to beloved local icons, from the cartoon bear Mis Uszatek to sculptural tributes celebrating the city's musical talents, such as the pianist Arthur Rubinstein.



Lodz has always been at the heart of creative production, first of textiles and later of images. It is the home of the renowned Lodz Film School, which has nurtured directors such as Andrzej Wajda and Roman Polanski. The city was vividly depicted in Wajda's film The Promised Land, a defining portrait of its industrial age. The old factories have not vanished but have been reinhabited. The vast Poznanski complex now thrives as Manufaktura, a cultural and urban quarter of museums, cinemas, galleries, restaurants, and public squares. The industrialists' houses, including the Herbst and Poznanski palaces, preserve the social architecture of that earlier world.



Even the underworld has its place on Lodz cultural map. Sections of historical sewer infrastructure, now open to visitors, evoke the city's atmospheric past. Above ground, visual culture circulates freely. Visit the Comics and Interactive Narration Centre. Here comics, animation, games, and graphic storytelling are treated as serious narrative arts, part of a lineage that runs from folklore to contemporary fantasy. In a Europe increasingly curated into predictable experiences, Łodz still feels like a place you have to meet on its own terms and that, in 2026, may be its most marvellous quality.